

The Message Stack

One approved set of words, so every deck, post, page and proposal makes the same argument.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Anyone writing on behalf of 3HUE — marketing, sales, the founder, or an outside agency. Copy from it directly.

WHAT MAKES IT TRUSTWORTHY

Every claim carries a substantiation status. Nothing marked *do not use* should reach a prospect, a page or a deck.

COMPANIONS

The Forcing Function says who to say it to. The *Brand Sheet* says how it should look. This says what it is.

01 The core narrative

Five beats. Every long-form piece — a keynote, a landing page, a founder article, a proposal introduction — is some subset of these in this order. Each beat carries the evidence that makes it defensible.

01

Proof became a condition of doing business

Security used to be something a company did for itself. It is now something customers, insurers, investors and regulators require it to demonstrate to them, on their timetable, in their format.

61% were required to hold a certification to win or renew a contract; 47% had sales cycles delayed; 38% lost revenue or bids. — Secureframe 2026 Benchmark

02

The standard response produces paper, not protection

Buy a platform, assemble evidence before the audit, pass once, go quiet for eleven months. It clears the gate and leaves the organization no safer — which everyone in the market now says out loud.

72% still rely on periodic assessments; only 28% monitor continuously. 78% of organizations that failed a recent audit had a prior breach history — roughly four times the rate of those that passed. — RegScale 2026 · Thales 2025

03

The constraint is not knowledge. It is capacity.

The frameworks are free and public. What organizations lack is anyone to run them. This is the beat most competitors skip, and it is the one that makes the buyer feel understood rather than sold to.

68% of organizations have one or fewer full-time security staff and roughly a third have none, while 93% call security a top priority. Around 35,000 CISOs exist for an estimated 359 million businesses. — Secureframe 2026 · Cybersecurity Ventures with Sophos 2026

04

What actually works is an operated program

Governance that someone owns, controls that run continuously, and evidence that regenerates itself instead of being reassembled. Deployed is not the same as operating — and the gap between the two is where both audits and incidents happen.

86.8% of small businesses have deployed MFA but only 51.1% require it across all key accounts; 88.4% hold backups and 61.4% have tested them. — National Cybersecurity Alliance with CISA, 2026

05

That is what 3HUE is

A founder-led firm that designs the program and then runs it, with a platform underneath that keeps the evidence current between audits. The person who scopes the work is the person who delivers it.

Substantiated by the published offer structure and the Transit Technologies engagement. See the claims library before quantifying anything further.

02 Positioning statement

Internal, not customer-facing copy. It exists to settle arguments about what 3HUE is and is not. Everything else in this document should be traceable to it.

For organizations that have been told to **prove** their security by a customer, insurer, investor or regulator, and have no one inside to do it, **3HUE** builds the governance program and then operates it — so the evidence is produced continuously rather than assembled before each audit. Unlike a compliance platform, which hands you a longer to-do list, or a vCISO bolted onto a help desk, **the practitioner who scopes the work delivers it**, and AiVRIC keeps the controls monitored between audits.

The one-sentence version

3HUE builds security and AI governance programs that someone actually runs — and proves they are running.

What we are not

- **Not a compliance platform.** We are the layer above one. Many good prospects already own Vanta or Drata; that is a qualifier, not a competitor.
- **Not a staffing firm.** Stated explicitly on the site. We do not place bodies against a rate card.
- **Not an audit firm.** We prepare organizations for auditors, manage the relationship and negotiate scope. We do not issue opinions.
- **Not a certificate mill.** If a prospect wants the fastest, cheapest paper, they are someone else's client and losing them is a feature.

03 Three pillars

Every proof point, case study and campaign should ladder to one of these. If a piece of content does not support one, it probably should not ship.

PILLAR 01

Operated, not advised

The program is built and then run. Advice without execution does not survive contact with a mid-market budget, and buyers say so plainly — it is execution that produces value for them.

"We don't hand you a plan. We run the program."

PILLAR 02

Provable, continuously

Evidence regenerates instead of being reassembled. That is what survives an examiner, an insurer's post-incident review, and a buyer's diligence — not a point-in-time report.

"Your controls passed in December. We can tell you what they were doing in March."

PILLAR 03

Founder-delivered

The same practitioner scopes and delivers. A career spent closing FDA 483 observations, bank MRAs and audit findings where the margin for error was zero — not a partner who sells and a junior who staffs.

"Nobody asked how. Ask us."

Pillar 03 is the hardest for competitors to copy and the easiest for 3HUE to lose. It only holds while Andrew is genuinely on the engagement; the moment delivery is delegated, the claim has to change. Flag it if that shifts.

04 The message by segment

Same narrative, three entry points. The opening line is the one that earns attention; the frame is what the rest of the conversation sits inside.

SEGMENT	OPENING LINE	THE FRAME	THE PROOF TO REACH FOR
Hue 01 The Provable Vendor B2B software, 50–500 staff	"Your buyer isn't asking whether you're secure. They're asking whether you can prove it by Friday."	Revenue, not risk. The cost of the blocked deal, the date it closes, and who will run the program so engineering does not have to.	Transit Technologies: no formal security program to SOC 2 Type I with zero findings, then multi-entity Type II.
Hue 02 The Portfolio PE and family offices under \$25B AUM	"Your bigger competitors run cyber diligence on 81% of deals. You run it on 29%."	Valuation and exit. One control set across every operating company, evidence that survives a buyer's diligence, reporting the investment committee can read.	Large North American bank: 1,000+ systems certified under one scalable GRC assessment framework.

SEGMENT	OPENING LINE	THE FRAME	THE PROOF TO REACH FOR
Hue 03 The Regulated Operator Community FIs, lenders, OT operators	"Your controls passed in December. The question is what they were doing in March."	Findings that close and stay closed. Named frameworks in the examiner's language, with continuous monitoring underneath instead of annual testing.	Andrew's record: FDA 483 observations closed, bank MRAs remediated under sustained examination.

Hue 03 is the only segment where NIST, ISO, COBIT and FFIEC belong in the opening line. In Hues 01 and 02, framework names in the headline lose the room — the buyer's vocabulary is deals, questionnaires, insurance and exits.

05 Claims library

The most important page in this document. Marketing gets into trouble at exactly one place — a number that felt true, repeated until it became policy. Every claim below carries a status. Nothing marked *do not use* should reach a prospect, a page, a deck or a proposal, including as a verbal aside on a call.

Claims about 3HUE

CLAIM	STATUS	BASIS	HOW TO USE IT
"SOC 2 Type I with zero findings"	● SUBSTANTIATED	Transit Technologies engagement, published on the customer stories page.	Always attached to that engagement. Never as a general promise about future audits.
"Multi-entity SOC 2 Type II across a software portfolio"	● SUBSTANTIATED	Same engagement.	The strongest Hue 01 and Hue 02 proof point 3HUE owns. Lead with it.

CLAIM	STATUS	BASIS	HOW TO USE IT
"1,000+ systems certified under one assessment framework"	● SUBSTANTIATED	Large North American bank engagement, published.	Usable, but the client is unnamed — say "a large North American bank," never imply a logo.
"AI Risk & Readiness Snapshot in 10 business days"	● SUBSTANTIATED	Published offer and headline commitment on 3hue.net.	Freely usable. It is the single most concrete thing on the website — use it more, not less.
"The same advisor who scopes the work delivers it"	● SUBSTANTIATED	Stated on the About page; structural to a founder-led firm.	Core differentiator. Stops being true the moment delivery is delegated — revisit then.
"11 years in business · BBB Accredited · A+"	● SUBSTANTIATED	Incorporated 27 July 2015; BBB accredited 28 Aug 2025, A+ rating.	Useful trust signal for SMB and regulated buyers. Weak with SaaS founders — omit there.
Andrew's record: FDA 483s closed, bank MRAs remediated	● SUBSTANTIATED	Stated in his published founder thesis, consistent across his writing.	The single best Hue 03 asset. Use in first person, from him, not as third-person marketing copy.
Named client logos beyond those published	● NEEDS PERMISSION	Only Transit Technologies and Rolly Marine appear publicly.	Get written consent before any new name appears anywhere. Assume no until confirmed.
"We reduce audit cost / time by X%"	● DO NOT USE	No measured baseline exists. No engagement has published before-and-after figures.	Blocked until 3HUE instruments its own delivery. Worth fixing — this is the claim buyers most want.

CLAIM	STATUS	BASIS	HOW TO USE IT
"Trusted by N companies" / any client count	● DO NOT USE	No verifiable count is public.	Blocked until someone confirms the number and is willing to stand behind it.
AiVRIC modules in beta or alpha sold as available	● QUALIFY IT	Only CloudSignals+RiskOps is marked available. AI Signals, AIRE Agentic Mesh, RogueAgent and Vision AI are beta, alpha or roadmap.	Say "available today" only for CloudSignals. Everything else is "in development" — in writing, every time.

Third-party statistics — cite the source every time

STATISTIC	STATUS	SOURCE TO CITE	BEST USED FOR
68% have ≤1 full-time security person; 93% call security a top priority	● VERIFIED	Secureframe, 2026 Benchmark (Dec 2025, n=255)	The capacity beat. The workhorse stat of the whole framework.
61% required a certification to win or renew; 38% lost revenue	● VERIFIED	Secureframe, 2026 Benchmark	The trigger beat, Hue 01.
81% vs 29% PE cyber diligence; \$2.1M average deal impact	● VERIFIED	Kroll, Private Equity Cybersecurity (Feb 2026, n=325)	Hue 02. The entire portfolio pitch rests on this.
~35,000 CISOs for ~359 million businesses (10,000:1)	● VERIFIED	Cybersecurity Ventures with Sophos, 2026 CISO Report	Why hiring is not the alternative.
72% periodic assessments vs 28% continuous	● VERIFIED	RegScale, 2026 State of Continuous Controls Monitoring (n=253)	Pillar 02.

STATISTIC	STATUS	SOURCE TO CITE	BEST USED FOR
78% of recent audit failures had prior breaches	● VERIFIED	Thales, 2025 Data Threat Report	The paper-doesn't-protect beat. Handle carefully — it is correlation.
MFA deployed 86.8%, required everywhere 51.1%	● VERIFIED	National Cybersecurity Alliance with CISA, 2026 (n=1,000)	"Deployed is not operating." The most vivid stat available.
MSPs offering vCISO: 21% → 67% in one year	● VERIFIED	Cynomi, 2025 State of the vCISO	Battlecard context. Also a warning about commoditization.
"40% of cyber insurance claims were denied"	● DO NOT USE	Appears in a LinkedIn post with no source attached; no carrier report supports it.	Use the <i>mechanism</i> instead — controls attested versus controls demonstrated at claim time. The story converts without the number.
Any dollar size for "the vCISO market"	● DO NOT USE	Only SEO aggregators publish one. No credible primary source found.	Blocked. Use the adoption trend instead.
Current TOGAF or COBIT adoption rates	● DO NOT USE	No current data exists. The newest ITIL adoption survey found is from 2020.	Blocked. Do not estimate.
"ISO 27001 certifications doubled"	● DO NOT USE	The apparent jump in the 2024 ISO Survey is a reporting-method change, not growth.	Cite the level (96,709 valid certificates) if needed, never the growth.
CMMC as a live, enforced requirement	● TIME-SENSITIVE	Phase II was suspended 13 July 2026 by the DoW CIO pending a reform task force. Phase I self-assessments, NIST SP 800-171 and DFARS 252.204-7012 still apply.	Re-verify before any defense-sector campaign. The correct line is "the certification paused; the controls didn't."

Two standing rules. Cite the source and the year in the asset itself, not just in a footnote — an uncited statistic in a deck becomes an unattributable one in a proposal. And treat every figure here as expiring: these are 2024–2026 surveys, most refresh annually, and a stat that is two cycles old reads as sloppy to the exact buyer 3HUE wants. Re-check this table each January.

06 **Objection handling**

These are the eight that actually come up, drawn from what buyers say in public rather than from what a sales team imagines they say. The move is never to argue the objection away — most of them are correct.

"We already have Vanta / Drata."

Do not treat this as a competitor. It is a qualifier — they have already spent money to solve this and are still not done.

Move: "Good — keep it. A platform tells you what is wrong. The question is who fixes it, who answers the questionnaire, and who negotiates scope with the auditor. That is the job we do, and we do it on top of the tool you already bought."

Buyer language: "most compliance tools just hand you a longer to-do list." Also: "Basic technical compliance is not the hard part. It's everything else."

"Isn't this just compliance theater?"

Agree immediately and completely. Arguing loses the room, because the market consensus is already on their side — a marquee CISO, the accounting press and a Pentagon CIO have all said it publicly.

Move: "Mostly, yes. A certificate says controls existed during a window. That is why we sell the operating layer and not the certificate — you get the report because your buyer needs it, and you get a program because you need it. Those are two different products and most firms only deliver the first."

Reference the Delve episode of March 2026 if the prospect is technical: 494 audit reports, 493 near-identical. It is the cleanest available proof that speed-to-certificate and actual security are different products.

"This is too expensive." / "We'll do it ourselves."

Almost always a framing problem, not a budget problem. Security spend is compared against other overhead; it should be compared against the blocked deal.

Move: "What is the contract worth that is waiting on this? Price the program against that, not against a tool subscription. And on doing it yourselves — you can, and some clients graduate to exactly that. The question is whether the person who would run it has eleven weeks free this year."

A founder on X: "Just lost a \$500k deal because we didn't have SOC 2. The consultant quoted us \$80,000 and 9 months." The comparison the buyer is already making is \$80K against \$500K.

"We're too small to be a target."

Rarely the real objection — usually a stand-in for "nothing is forcing me." Check for a trigger before spending effort here.

Move: "Targeting stopped being how this works. Automated campaigns scan for what is reachable. But the more useful question is who has asked you to prove something recently — a customer, your insurer, an investor? If nobody has, we are early and I would rather come back when they do."

The Cyber Threat Alliance CEO, publicly: "too small to target is another version of the old security by obscurity approach... it is most assuredly dead now."

"Our MSP already does this."

Two-thirds of MSPs now claim a vCISO service, up from a fifth a year ago. Most of it is advisory attached to a help desk.

Move: "Ask them three questions: which framework are we assessed against, who signs off on risk acceptance, and what happens when an auditor challenges a control. If the answers are good, you are in fine shape. If they are vague, that is the gap we fill — and we work alongside your MSP, not instead of them."

67% of MSPs and MSSPs now offer vCISO services, up from 21% in 2024 (Cynomi 2025). A vCISO practitioner's own warning: bolt-on compliance "doesn't hold up when a client has a real audit, a breach, or a board member who asks the hard questions."

"Why not just hire someone?"

The honest answer is that they should, eventually — and saying so builds more trust than defending the engagement.

Move: "Eventually you should. A full-time security leader runs \$250,000 to \$400,000 and takes three to six months to find, and at your size they would be under-used for the first year. We run the program now and build it so an internal hire inherits something rather than starting over."

\$250–400K compensation range and the 10,000:1 business-to-CISO ratio, Cybersecurity Ventures with Sophos 2026. 38–39% of roles take three to six months to fill (ISACA 2025).

"Can you guarantee we pass?"

No, and the answer must be no. Anyone promising otherwise is describing the thing that just blew up publicly.

Move: "No. What I can do is tell you before we start whether you will pass, scope the work to what the standard actually requires rather than what the tool suggests, and manage the auditor relationship so there are no surprises. If we find something that will not clear in your timeline, you will hear it from me in week two, not from the auditor in month six."

The most valuable skill in this work, per practitioners, is "managing down the scope of the framework." Sell that, not a guarantee.

"How is this different from a Big 4 readiness engagement?"

Comes up in Hue 03 and in PE portfolios. Do not disparage — differentiate on delivery model.

Move: "They will do good work and you will get a partner in the pitch and a team of two-year analysts on the engagement. Here, the person in the room is the person doing the work, the scope stays where we set it, and when the report is delivered we are still running the program. That last part is usually the difference that matters."

Continuity is the differentiator, not price. Do not compete on rate against a firm that can discount deeper.

07 Battlecards

Four real alternatives. Note that the fourth — doing nothing — wins more deals than the other three combined, which is why the trigger question matters more than any competitive argument.

Compliance platforms

Vanta · Drata · Secureframe · Sprinto · Comp AI

WHERE THEY WIN

Speed, price transparency, evidence automation, and a name the board recognizes. For a 25-person startup with a clean environment and a technical founder who will do the work, they are genuinely the right answer.

WHERE THEY LOSE

They surface findings and cannot close them. Buyers who have been through it say the tool creates a longer to-do list and that "basic technical compliance is not the hard part — it's everything else." They also cannot negotiate scope with an auditor or answer a 200-question review.

WHAT TO SAY

"Keep the platform. We're the layer that operates it — and we'll get more out of the licence you're already paying for."

WHAT NOT TO SAY

Never attack the tool. A large share of good prospects own one, and criticizing it tells them their judgment was poor. Position above it, never against it.

The MSP's vCISO add-on

The incumbent IT provider, upselling security

WHERE THEY WIN

Incumbency, one invoice, and an existing relationship with the person who would otherwise be 3HUE's champion. Cheap, because it is bundled.

WHERE THEY LOSE

Advisory attached to a help desk. Two-thirds of MSPs now claim the service, mostly trained-up account managers rather than practitioners, and it does not survive a real audit, a breach or a board question. Independence is also compromised — the MSP is auditing its own work.

WHAT TO SAY

"Who signs off on risk acceptance today? If it's the same firm that runs your infrastructure, that's a conflict an examiner will find before you do."

WHAT NOT TO SAY

Do not force a rip-and-replace. The winning posture is alongside the MSP — they keep the infrastructure, 3HUE owns governance. That also makes the MSP a referral channel rather than an enemy.

The solo fractional CISO

An independent practitioner on retainer

WHERE THEY WIN

Cheapest credible option, senior person in the room, personal relationship. Often genuinely excellent, and this is the closest substitute for what 3HUE sells.

WHERE THEY LOSE

One person, no platform, no continuity. Evidence lives in their spreadsheets. If they take a full-time role — and the market is pulling hard — the program leaves with them. They also cannot absorb liability the way a firm can.

WHAT TO SAY

"What happens to your program if that person takes a full-time job? Ours runs on a platform your team keeps, with a firm behind it."

WHAT NOT TO SAY

Do not disparage individuals — several are respected voices this market listens to, and 3HUE's own differentiator is a named practitioner. Compete on continuity and infrastructure, not on seniority.

Doing nothing

The most common outcome, and the real competitor

WHERE IT WINS

Always, until something forces a decision. Budget goes to whatever is on fire. More than half of SMBs admit to no formal risk framework and nearly two-thirds are not confident they could recover from an incident — and they still do not buy.

WHERE IT LOSES

Only at a trigger: a blocked contract, an insurance renewal, diligence, an exam finding, a customer's AI questionnaire. Not at a fear appeal.

WHAT TO SAY

"Who has asked you to prove something recently, and by when?" If the honest answer is nobody, say so and set a reminder for their renewal date.

WHAT NOT TO SAY

Do not try to manufacture urgency with breach statistics. It does not convert, and it makes 3HUE sound like every other security vendor in the inbox. Qualify out honestly and stay in touch — that is what wins the deal six months later.

08 Words we use, words we don't

Drawn from how buyers actually speak in public, and from what the market has stopped responding to. The left column is language prospects used themselves; the right is language that either signals nothing or actively loses the room.

Use

Their vocabulary, not ours.

- **Provable** — the whole positioning in one word. "The competitor that won wasn't better. They were provable."
- **Operated / runs / we run it** — the distinction from advisory.
- **Evidence** — concrete, auditable, and what buyers actually need to hand someone.
- **Accountable / someone owns it** — "You don't need a full-time CISO. You need someone accountable."
- **Scope** — as a verb. Telling a buyer what they *don't* have to do is the most differentiated promise available.
- **Blocked deal, renewal, diligence, the exam** — name the trigger in the buyer's own words.
- **Deployed is not operating** — the single most useful phrase in the framework.
- **Continuous / between audits** — where the product actually lives.

Avoid

Not because they're wrong — because they no longer land.

- **"Compliance ≠ security"** as a headline — now consensus, so it signals nothing. Fine as the setup, never as the point.
- **Maturity scores and levels** — "nobody outside security knows what Level 3 maturity means." Say months, cost and who does the work instead.
- **ITIL, COBIT, TOGAF** outside Hue 03 — no live conversation on any platform, and the association is "four years of talk."
- **"One-click," "effortless," "automated compliance"** — the market watched that promise collapse in March 2026. It now reads as a warning sign.
- **"Cutting-edge," "best-in-class," "trusted partner"** — filler that any competitor could sign.
- **Fear-first breach statistics** — high awareness, low conversion, and indistinguishable from every other vendor email.
- **"Enterprise-grade"** for SMB buyers — it reads as "priced for someone else."

- **Acronyms in a first sentence** — a founder who lost a deal over SOC 2 may still not know what the letters stand for.

On voice. Andrew's own writing is the reference: declarative, practitioner-first, willing to name a failure mode, allergic to consultant abstraction. "Governance without informed operational authority is theater." "Tools do not reduce risk, decisions do." "AI does not create maturity, it reveals it." Copy written for 3HUE should sound like it could survive being read aloud by him on a client call. If a sentence would embarrass him in front of a CISO, cut it.

09 Boilerplate

Approved standing descriptions. Use verbatim — the point of boilerplate is that it does not vary between a press release, a speaker bio and a proposal cover.

25 WORDS · DIRECTORY LISTINGS, SOCIAL BIOS, SPEAKER CREDITS

3HUE builds and operates security, compliance and AI governance programs for organizations that have to prove their controls work — and have no one inside to run them.

50 WORDS · PRESS, PARTNER PAGES, PROPOSAL FOOTERS

3HUE Executive Consulting is a founder-led advisory and managed services firm serving regulated and operationally complex organizations. It designs security, compliance and AI governance programs and then operates them, producing continuous evidence rather than point-in-time reports. Founded in 2015 and based in South Florida, 3HUE also built AiVRIC, the platform its managed programs run on.

100 WORDS · ABOUT PAGE, CAPABILITY STATEMENTS, RFP RESPONSES

3HUE Executive Consulting is a founder-led advisory and managed services firm for organizations that have been told to prove their security by a customer, insurer, investor or regulator. Rather than delivering an assessment and leaving, 3HUE builds the governance program and then runs it — audit-ready security programs, managed security operations, and technology governance — with evidence produced continuously instead of assembled before each audit. Engagements are scoped and delivered by the same practitioner, whose background includes closing FDA 483 observations and remediating bank Matters Requiring Attention under sustained examination. Founded in 2015. Its managed programs run on AiVRIC, the platform 3HUE built.

Open naming question this document cannot settle: how 3HUE and AiVRIC appear together. The options are endorsement ("AiVRIC, from 3HUE"), a powered-by relationship ("3HUE managed programs, running on AiVRIC"), or full separation. The drafts above use powered-by because it is the most defensible today, but this is a decision for Andrew, and once made it belongs in the Brand Sheet as a rule.

3HUE Message Stack · version 1 · September 2, 2026. Derived from *The Maturity Gap* research and *The Forcing Function* ICP. Every claim carries a substantiation status; re-check the statistics table each January, and re-verify anything CMMC-related before use.